

YULIA VALDIVIA RIVERA

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EDUCATION

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

2023 - Present

Ph.D. in Public Policy

Universidad del Pacífico (Lima, Peru)

M.Sc. in Economics

2018-2020

Thesis: “Free Trade and Mortality in Children: Adverse Effects of the Free Trade Agreements (FTA) with the United States”

Advisor: Alberto Chong

Relevant coursework: Real Analysis; Advanced Econometrics I & II; Microeconomics I & II, Macroeconomics I & II, Bayesian Econometrics; Measure Theory; Labor Economics; Economics of the Family; and Applied Economic Methods.

B.Sc. in Economics

2013-2018

Thesis: “Do large oil spills have effects on labor outcomes? The Peruvian case”

Advisor: Alberto Chong

Maastricht University (Maastricht, Netherlands)

January - July 2017

International exchange program. Courses: Actuarial Mathematics; Understanding Society (Applied Economics); Justice and the Political Process (Public Choice Theory); and Public Management Reform and Public Entrepreneurship (Public Economics).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

World Bank, Poverty and Equity Global Practice

May 2021 - August 2023

Research Assistant

- Research assistance on the distributional analysis of fiscal policy, labor market, climate change, migration, gender, and other issues related to poverty and inequality.
- Elaborated the Poverty Assessment for Peru and the Peru’s CEQ Assessment on the impact of the tax-transfer system on poverty and inequality. For this analysis, I implemented the survey correction method of Blanchet et al. (2019), estimated the indirect effects of the VAT using the Price-Shifting Model of Coady & Newhouse (2006), and calibrated the potential impact of a carbon tax on poverty and inequality following Malerba et al. (2019).
- Led the distributional analysis from the World Bank Country Office on the fiscal reform proposed by the Ministry of Economics (November 2021).
- Led the analysis on the impact of climate change on poverty that was included in the Country Climate and Development Report (CCDR) for Peru.
- Elaborated reports on the integration of the Venezuelan population in the Peruvian labor market and analyzed Venezuelan migration in Peru for regional and national reports.

Peruvian Institute of Economics (IPE)

Economist

August 2018 - April 2021

- Applied research for the analysis of public policies and the design of policy reforms, commissioned by local and international companies, the public sector, and international organizations. My work required strong quantitative and programming skills to analyze data on poverty, taxation, labor, pension system, among others.

- Led the simulations to advise the Commission for Sustainable Mining Development towards the design of a new General Mining Law (2019) and the Commission in Charge of Assessing, Designing, and Proposing the Project for the Comprehensive Reform of the Peruvian Pension System (2020). Both commissions were entrusted by the Peruvian Government and were constituted by researchers and experts from the private and public sectors.
- Evaluated the impact of Antamina mining operations in its area of direct influence using Propensity Score Matching.
- Led the build-up of the 2019 and 2020 editions of the Regional Competitiveness Index (INCORE) and assisted in the elaboration of the Regional Public Management Index (IRGP).
- Lecturer of Stata at IPE's Seminars in public universities in Cusco, Ayacucho and Huancavelica regions.

Intern

April 2018 - July 2018

- Research assistance in the elaboration of INCORE 2018. Handled household survey and administrative data and prepared economic activity reports.

APOYO Consulting Group (Lima, Peru)

January 2016 - December 2016

Intern in the area of Economic Studies

Assisted in the elaboration of reports on infrastructure, mining, electricity, and agriculture sectors. Handled data, reviewed bibliography, and prepared reports about economic activity.

Research Center of Universidad del Pacífico

May 2015 - October 2015

Research Assistant of Professor Enrique Vásquez

Research assistance on the estimation of Multidimensional Poverty for the elaboration of a discussion document for the Economic and Social Research Consortium.

WORKING PAPERS

Expanding Lawful Pathways: The Economic Impact of New Migration Policies in the U.S.

Doctoral Research

This study investigates how granting deportation protection and work authorization to immigrants in the United States influence economic opportunities for both migrants and native workers. By exploiting the expansion of the Temporary Protected Status (TPS) program, this paper aims to explore the extent to which the TPS affects labor market behavior among beneficiaries, and if it creates competition for jobs or complements the labor supply. This paper contributes to the understanding of how recent policies that expand lawful pathways to immigrate into the U.S. influence labor markets dynamics.

Child Mortality and the Unexpected Effect of Deep Trade Agreements

with Alberto Chong and Alejandro Riano

Child mortality has been declining secularly across the world at the same time that globalization has advanced and deepened. Are these two trends related? We use a staggered adoption difference-in-differences design based on countries' first signature of a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) over the period 1990 to 2019. We find that while earlier episodes of unilateral trade liberalization have led to a decline in child mortality, the use of broader and more encompassing FTAs has resulted in a reduction in the decline rate of child mortality. Countries that have signed deep FTAs see an increase of 4 deaths per 1,000 live births relative to the counterfactual group based on countries that have yet to sign an FTA, but that do so during our period of analysis. The effect of FTAs on child mortality is highly heterogeneous across countries depending on the timing of introduction. We examine how the effect varies across children's age and FTA characteristics and explore some potential mechanisms that explain the impact.

Presented at City, University of London, University of Surrey, Brunel University and LACEA LAMES 2022.

Is the enforcement of labor regulations effective in promoting formal employment? The Peruvian case

with Florencia Pinto and Hernan Winkler

This paper studies the impact of increasing the enforcement of labor inspections on labor market outcomes in Peru from 2010 to 2019. We exploit the creation of SUNAFIL -the National Labor Inspection Office- and its gradual rollout as a source of variation in the level of public enforcement. Even though the decentralization of SUNAFIL significantly increased the number and size of fines levied on formal firms, we do not find any significant effects on the employment rate. We find a significant but negligible positive effect on employment in the formal sector. In addition, although we find statistically significant and negative effects on the informality rate for all workers and for workers in the formal sector -the sector targeted by the SUNAFIL-, the magnitudes are very small.

Presented at LACEA LAMES 2022 and the Jobs and Development Conference “The Challenge of Creating Better Jobs in Developing Countries” 2022.

NON-ACADEMIC PUBLICATIONS

Joint Data Center, World Bank & UNHCR (2024). Challenges and opportunities of the economic integration of the Venezuelan population in the Peruvian labor market

with Natalia Garbiras-Díaz and Eliana Rubiano

World Bank (2023). Rising Strong: Peru Poverty and Equity Assessment

with Luciana De la Flor

Chapter 3 - The Distributional Effects of the Tax and Transfer System (The CEQ Assessment for Peru)

ILO & CONFIEP (2022). Policy proposals towards a sustainable and inclusive business environment that allows achieving the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) of the 2030 Agenda

with Cesar Liendo

IPE (2021). Assessing the Peruvian Mining Sector’s Taxation Structure

with Valeria Churango and Martin Valencia

IPE (sixteen weekly publications during March – July 2020). COVID-19 Pandemic’s Impact on the Peruvian Economy

with Valeria Churango, Rodrigo Eyzaguirre, Fernando Gonzales and Martin Valencia

TEACHING ASSISTANCE

University of Chicago, Harris School of Public Policy

PhD course, Advanced Microeconomics II

Winter 2025, Winter 2026

PhD course, Applied Econometrics I

Fall 2024

Program Evaluation (Master’s) – Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026

Math Methods for Public Policy (Master’s) – Teaching Assistant

Summer 2024

Math Methods for Public Policy (Master’s) – Instructor

Fall 2024, Summer 2025, Fall 2025

Universidad del Pacífico, Graduate School

Fundamentals of Advanced Econometrics

Spring 2020, 2021 and 2022

Universidad del Pacífico, Undergraduate level

Time Series and Panel Data Econometrics

Fall 2018, 2020 and 2021

Portfolio Theory

Spring 2018

Foundations of Macroeconomics

Spring 2018

Macroeconomics I

Fall 2017

CONFERENCES AND SEMINARS

Presenter at the Jobs and Development Conference	Dec 2022
Presenter at LACEA-LAMES Annual Meetings 2022	Nov 2022
Participant in the Summer University, World Bank	Jul 2022
BREAD-IGC Virtual Ph.D. Course on Migration	Apr 2022
Causal Inference and Research Design Seminar with Scott Cunningham	Aug 2021
Behavioral Government Lab Workshop	Dec 2019
World Bank Seminars	
Migrants, Refugees and Societies	Sep 2022
Tools to Analyze the Distributional Impacts of Trade	Nov 2021
Global Income Distribution Dynamics microsimulation model for climate change	Sep 2021
Fiscal Microsimulation Model Workshop	May 2021
Lecturer of Stata for Economists, IPE's Seminar	2019 - 2020
Responsible for five hours of classes to 80 economic students from the public universities in Cusco (2018), Ayacucho (2019) and Huancavelica (2019).	

GRANTS AND AWARDS

Becker Friedman Institute for Economics and the Data, Policy, and Innovation Centre data acquisition grant. "Why they leave: Vulnerability, coping, and public policy in Odisha". Total value: \$5,000.

Travel grant to present at the Jobs and Development Conference "The Challenge of Creating Better Jobs in Developing Countries" in Cape Town, South Africa, on December 14-15, 2022. Total estimated value: \$4,000.

"Project your future: reducing search friction in youth employment in Peru" selected for the First call for the Laboratory of Labor Innovation of the Ministry of Labor and Employment Promotion.

PODER Magazine's Award to the IPE for Best Political Economy Research in 2020, for the publication of the "COVID-19 Pandemic's Impact on the Peruvian Economy"

Undergraduate thesis selected among the best four economic research papers prepared by students in 2018 and included in the repository of Universidad del Pacífico.

Fellowship for the international exchange program at Maastricht University in 2017, Universidad del Pacífico. Total estimated value: \$5,000.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Programming Skills	Stata, R, ArcGIS, Julia, and MATLAB
Languages	Spanish (Native), English (Advanced)